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The Rowdy Robot | North America

What Stocks Will the Robots Buy?

Thought experiment: Recently at the Jonas family dinner table, I asked my kids to imagine a future world populated entirely by robots and no people. In this hypothetical world, we must imagine that the robots will want to expand their population - by any means necessary. We wouldn't want robots that just sit around all day and do nothing - that'd be lame. **In this robot world, what industries would be most valued - what stocks would they buy?**

Basic necessities for sustainable robot life:

- **Energy.** You can't have GPUs without BTUs. If I told you these robots had no sense of 'time' in the way carbon-based intelligent life does, then they will quickly exhaust all sources of terrestrial energy. Solar is critical here with a fusion reactor just 93 million miles away. They'll want to get as much of that as possible before exploiting other star systems.
- **Metals.** 75% of the periodic table. Securing and processing the precious ores from the earth's crust will be critical, followed by lunar mining, near-Earth asteroids, nearby planets... before tackling bigger metallic prey.
- **Non-metals.** Broadly defined - all other atoms such as hydrogen, nitrogen, chlorine, metalloids (i.e., arsenic, silicon), noble gases and halogens. Virtually every element will play a role in the robot economy. **Substances matter (think about it).**
- **Water.** Robots may not 'feel' thirst, but they will need water for a wide range of processes and inputs: Dissolving chemicals, making batteries, growing crystals, cooling/thermal properties and much more. They will also prefer to stay clean.
- **Factories.** Think of these as the 'nurseries' of future generations of robots. The Promethean progeny. Needed to pass on improvements learned from experiences and environmental changes. A stream of materials enter the factory which transforms the atoms into complete robots (and robot replacement parts - think of that as robot healthcare). *Read more on the 'Factory Mother': [Tesla Inc: Factory Mother, Robo Delivery, The Secret, HAL 9000 \(30 Jun 2025\)](#)*
- **Transport.** Conveyance of materials from the Earth's crust to be processed, transformed into products and distributed through fulfillment networks is critical. The circulatory system of the robot economy.
- **Recycling.** There will be other factories that disassemble old or defective robots to help make new and improved robots/parts. If this sounds like a scene out of Star Wars, well... **there is no monopoly on imagination.**
- **Space.** The connective tissue of a robot civilization. Satellite networks link billions of robot agents across form factors over land, sea, air, and space,

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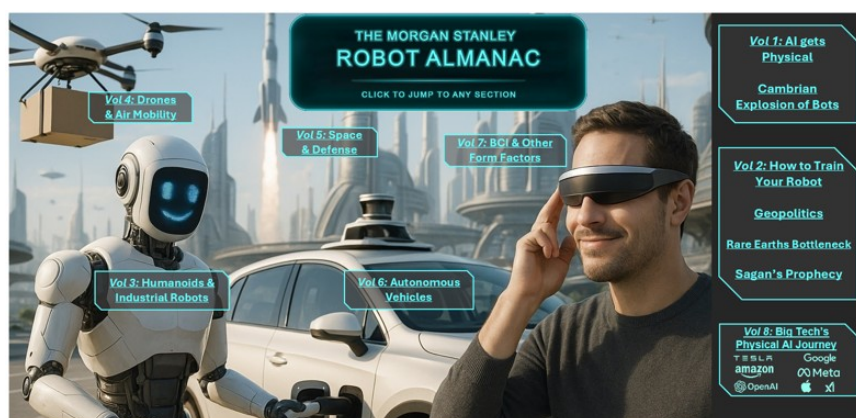
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allowing them to coordinate and share intelligence in real time. Abundant solar power, microgravity, and the thermal management benefits of space may enable entirely new kinds of infrastructure beyond what is practical on Earth.

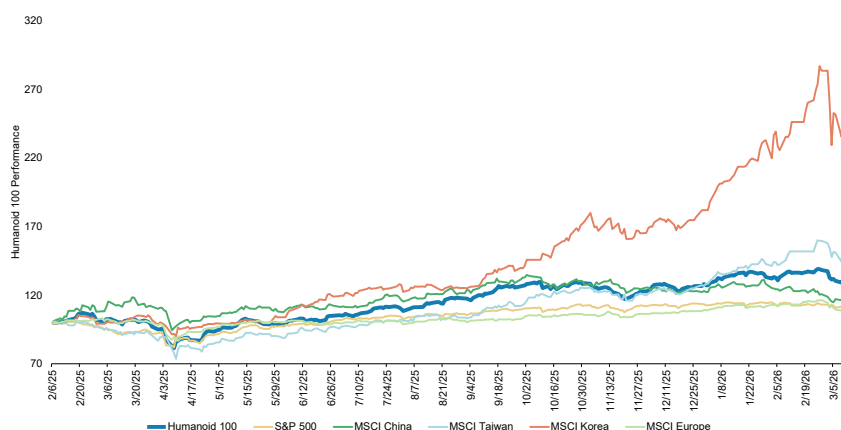
Author's note: The above list is far from exhaustive and is meant to focus on a 'first principles' basis. Of course, robots will care very much about specific applications/ industrial expressions such as batteries, semis, sensors, encoders, electric motors/ actuators, satellites, rockets, etc...

Exhibit 1: See the 8 Volumes of [The Morgan Stanley Robot Almanac](#) for Thoughts Across All Things Robots & Physical AI



Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 2: Humanoid 100 vs. Key Global Benchmarks Since 2/9/2025
(Humanoid 100 Inception)



Note: As of 3/11/2026.

Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 3: The Morgan Stanley Humanoid 100: Global Robotics Enablers

Foundational Models				Data Science & Analytics		Cybersecurity		Brain Simulation & Vision Software		Semis (Vision & Compute)		Semis (Designers)		Semis (Fab)		Integrators	
Actuators & Actuator Parts				Sensors		Batteries		Semis (Analog)		Body, Wiring, Thermal Management Castings		Diversified Automation					
Gearings				Radar & Lidar		E/Energy		ALLEGRO		MAGNA		Honeywell					
Complex Actuators								ANALOG DEVICES									

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

For Further Reading:

- Physical AI: The Morgan Stanley Robot Almanac (7 Dec 2025)
- The Rowdy Robot: Space 1493 (11 Mar 2026)
- Rowdy Robot: Can it Change a Diaper? (9 Mar 2026)
- Rowdy Robot: Picks & Shovels Robot Expressions: Semis (5 Mar 2026)
- Rowdy Robot: Picks & Shovels Robot Plays: Bearings (25 Feb 2026)
- Brain Computer Interfaces: Neuralink Hits 21 Patients; Precision/Medtronic Partnership; Altman's Merge Labs (25 Feb 2026)
- Space: Varda Space: Space Manufacturing, Pharma Made in Orbit (19 Feb 2026)

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	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
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Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	588	16%	87	10%	15%	220	13%
Total	3,710		906			1636	

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